Supply Chain Detective

IB Digital Society · Economics · Student assignment · 16 October 2026

One assignment. One page. One defensible judgement.

Your task

Investigate ONE bounded route:

Amazon option: one physical product from order to delivery.

Netflix option: one digital title from play request to the viewer.

Show how the service moves, explain one digital decision, and judge one stakeholder consequence. Do not investigate the whole company.

What to hand in

Choose one format:

- One-page Google Doc with an annotated route and about 250–350 words.
- Two-minute spoken explanation with the same annotated route and a short source list.

Both formats must contain the same six parts listed below.

Practice first — do not submit this

Open the visual lesson and Northstar practice lab.

Run the baseline and one growth choice. Use the result only to practise explaining a benefit, a new responsibility and a limitation. Your Northstar download is a practice record, not this assignment.

Do this in order

1. Choose and name one route. Keep the boundary narrow enough to show in 4–6 stages.
2. Map 4–6 connected stages. Label where the goods or service, money, data and control move.
3. Explain one digital decision. Identify its input, the rule or process, its output and who controls it.
4. Analyse one stakeholder. Explain one benefit, one cost or responsibility, and one possible longer-term implication.
5. Use two credible sources. At least one must be independent of the company. Put a source beside the stage or claim it supports. Mark one uncertain link with a question.
6. Make a judgement. Recommend one realistic change or safeguard. State one condition that would make you change your recommendation.

Response structure

Route and inquiry question · Annotated route · Digital decision · Stakeholder consequence · Judgement and limitation · Sources

Model of the expected reasoning — different case

A bakery buys its flour supplier. This is vertical growth because the supplier stage moves inside the bakery. The bakery may gain more control over supply, but it now carries production, food-safety and staffing responsibilities. Before recommending the move, an adviser would need evidence about total cost, reliability and worker conditions.

Starting sources

- Netflix Open Connect — how Netflix and internet service providers deliver content.
- Amazon annual reports — company information about operations, risks and investment.
- US Department of Labor Amazon settlement — an independent regulatory record about required ergonomic measures.

You may use one source from your existing Netflix or Amazon inquiry. Record the author or organization, title, date, URL and the exact fact you used.

Success checklist

- My route covers one product order or one digital-title delivery, not the whole company.
- My map has 4–6 connected stages and labels data and control.
- I explain how one digital decision works.
- I connect a benefit and a cost or responsibility to a named stakeholder.
- I use two sources, including one independent source, and mark one uncertain link.
- My recommendation includes a limitation and a condition that could change my judgement.

If the simulation is unavailable

Use slides 4–12 of the teaching deck as your practice. Complete the bakery check on slide 11, explain what changed, then begin this assignment. You do not need to reproduce the Northstar calculations.

Submission and saving

Create your response in your own Google Doc, or use the agreed spoken option with the annotated route. Submit through the Google Classroom assignment identified by your teacher.

Google Drive saves your assignment draft. The lesson page and Northstar lab do not submit anything to your teacher. Downloaded lab results are practice records only.